

Hoi An Travel Choice Study

Determinants of Destination Choice Intention Among Vietnamese Tourists (N=433, PLS-SEM)

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Executive Summary & Context

Empirical insights into domestic decision-making in a World Cultural Heritage site during Vietnam's tourism recovery.

Market Context & Research Gap

- ◆ **Domestic Anchor:** Vietnam's domestic market exceeded 110M trips in 2024, acting as the primary economic stabilizer post-pandemic.
- ◆ **Global Prestige:** Hoi An is ranked Top 2 World's Trending Destinations 2023 & No. 1 Best-Value Destination worldwide.
- ◆ **Literature Gap:** Previous studies focus heavily on domestic and international inbound travelers, neglecting Vietnamese decision drivers.
- ◆ **Practical Gap:** The lack of clarity regarding the role and relative influence of PBC, economic concerns, and social influence.
- ◆ **Practical Need:** Destination managers require empirical data on how domestic tourists weigh culture, price, and social e-WOM.



Objectives & Theoretical Framework

Research Objectives

Quantify the direct impacts of 6 primary factors on Travel Choice Intention (TI):

- Social Influence (SI)
- Perceived Behavioral Control (PBC)
- Destination Features (DF)
- Tourism Infrastructure (TIN)
- Destination Image (DI)
- Economic Concerns (EC)

Determine which factors have the **strongest impact** and which **still require improvement**.

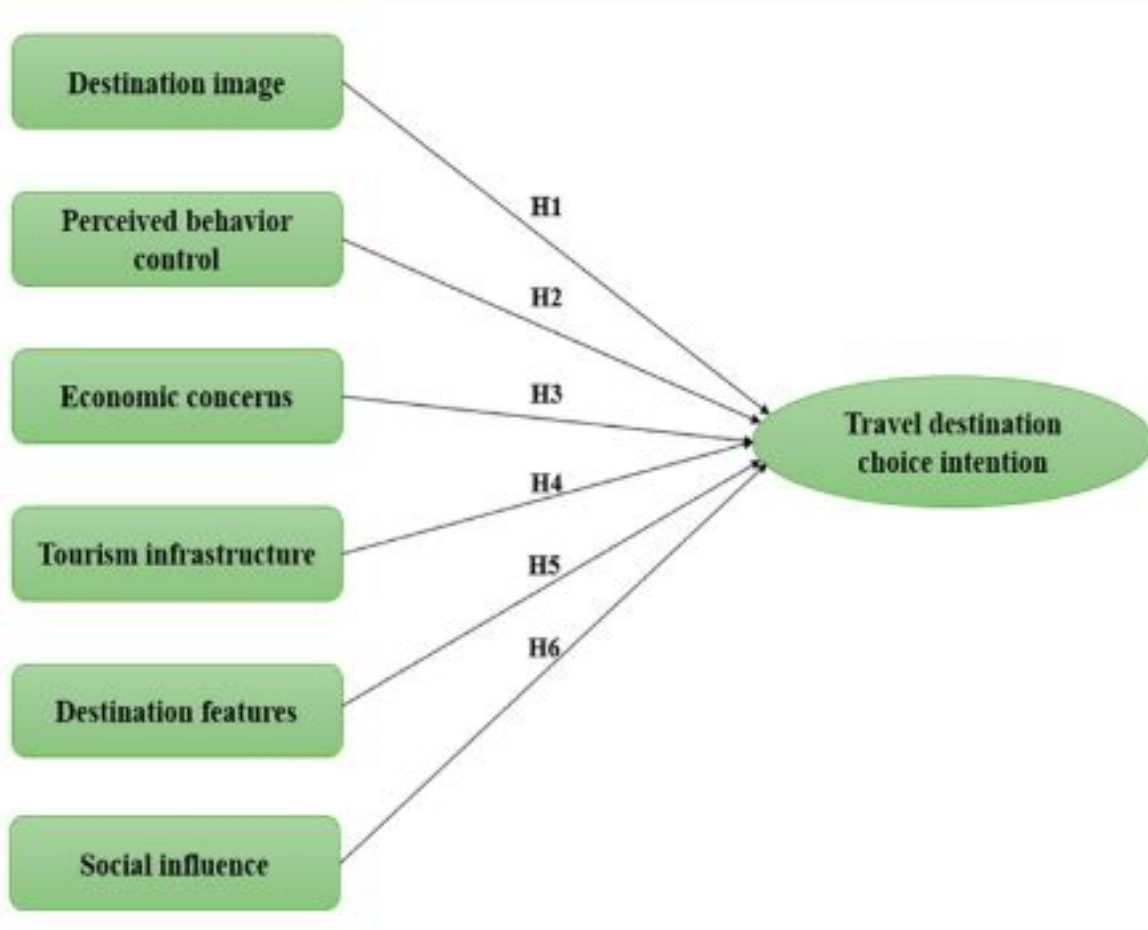
Propose practical implications to enhance Hoi An's attractiveness to Vietnamese tourists

Extended TPB Framework

Extends Ajzen's Theory of Planned Behavior (TPB) by integrating external destination attributes:

- Subjective norm (social pressure/expectations from important others).
- Attitude toward the behavior (how positively or negatively they evaluate it).
- Perceived Behavioral Control (PBC) (how capable and “in control” they feel).

Methodology Overview



Target population:

Vietnamese citizens who participated in a survey.

Sampling method:

Non-probability sampling (convenience/volunteer-based).

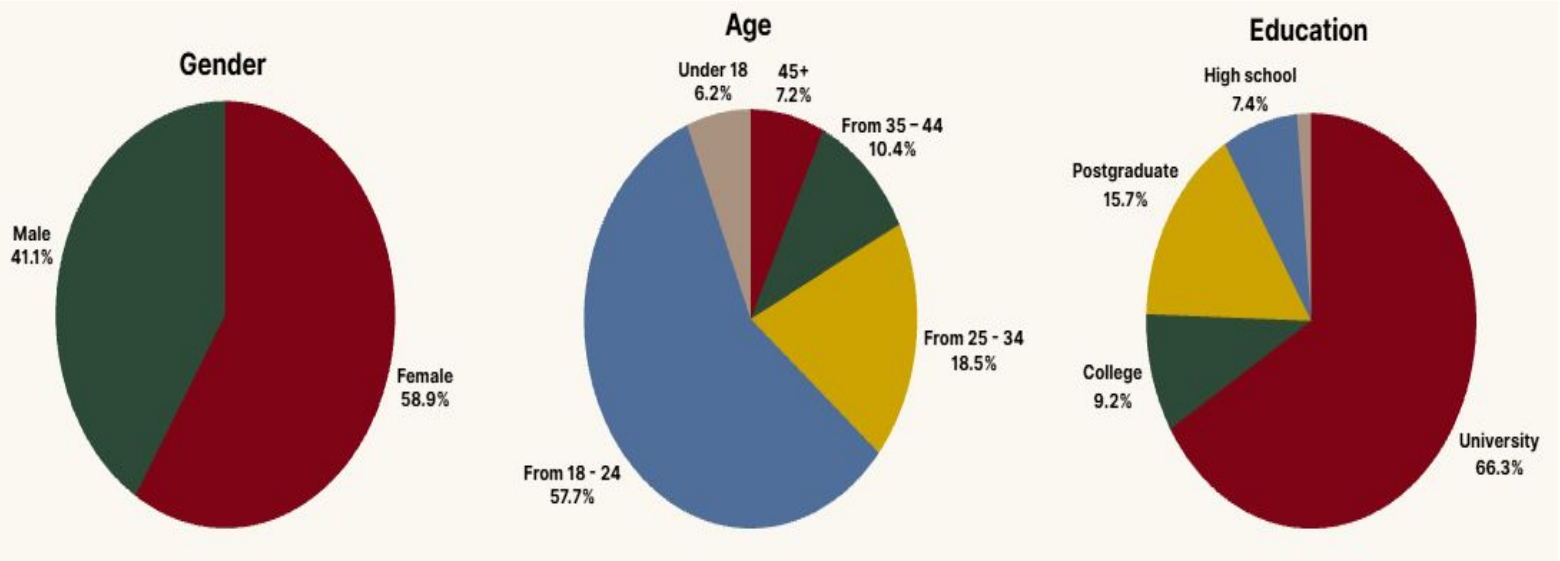
Sample size:

Minimum of 300 respondents → good (Osborne et al, 2005).

Recruitment channels:

- Online: social media, tourism communities.
- On-site in Hoi An: Old Town & key attractions (in-person survey).

Sample Demographic Overview



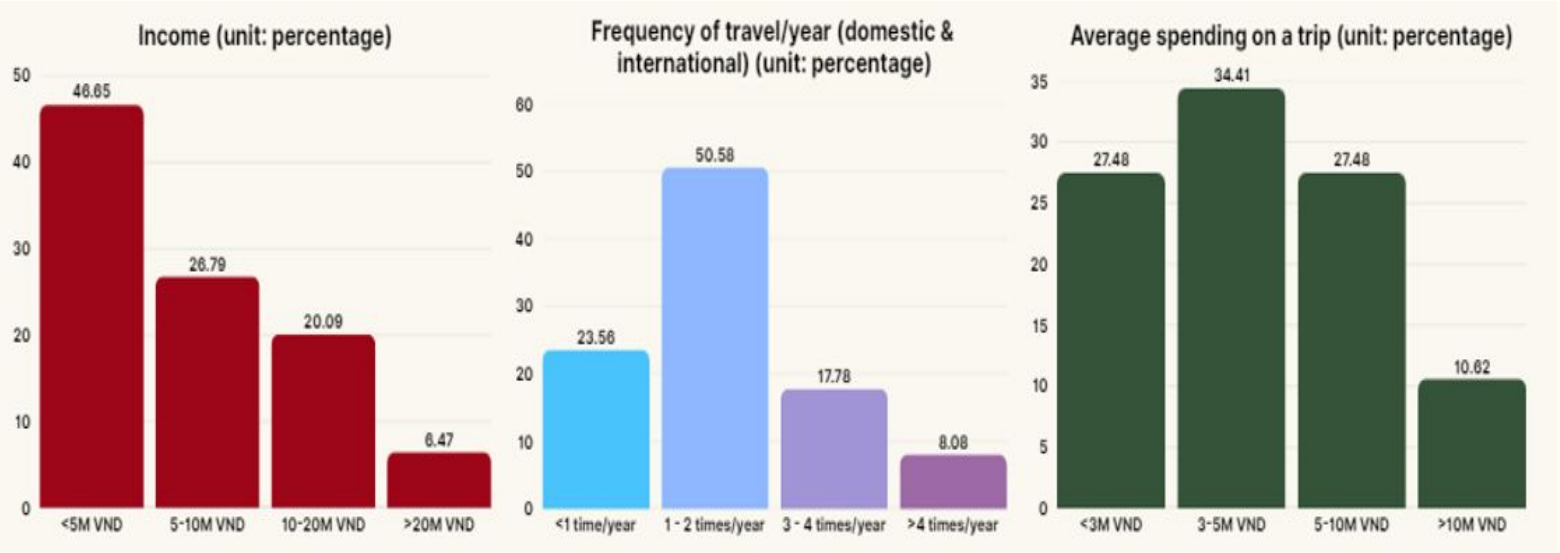
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Valid Survey Responses

Gender: Females constitute the majority (58.9%) => women often play an active role in travel planning and choosing services for the group.

Age Distribution: 57.7% Youth / Gen Z (18–24 years) => the generation of “digital natives” who grew up with the internet and love to explore, easily influenced by emerging travel trends.

Education: Highly educated => open-minded and demand transparency.

Income & Budget: 73.4% earn <10M VND/month; 34.4% spend 3–5M VND per getaway trip => price-sensitive segment, but they’re still willing to allocate a meaningful budget when they feel the trip is worth it.

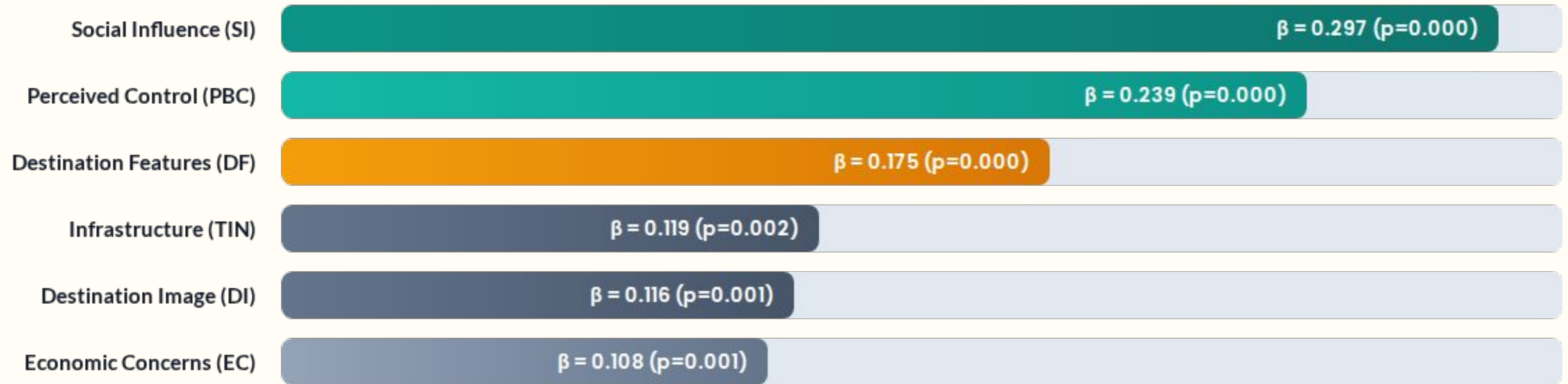


Measurement Model Reliability

Construct	Items	Cronbach's α	Composite Rel.	AVE	Inner VIF	F-square
Social Influence (SI)	4	0.882	0.919	0.740	2.314	0.222
Perceived Behavioral Control (PBC)	5	0.890	0.919	0.695	3.234	0.103
Destination Features (DF)	9	0.883	0.906	0.517	3.743	0.047
Tourism Infrastructure (TIN)	6	0.831	0.877	0.543	3.043	0.027
Destination Image (DI)	5	0.832	0.882	0.598	2.691	0.029
Economic Concerns (EC)	3	0.739	0.852	0.657	2.265	0.030
Tourism infrastructure (TI)	6	0.927	0.948	0.820		

All scales are trustworthy, the results confirm that the measurement model is solid. The model is strong, stable, and the biggest real-world drivers are clearly SI and PBC.

Determinant Impact Ranking



Substantial Predictive Power: The empirical structural model accounts for $R^2 = 82.8\%$ (Adj. $R^2 = 0.826$) of total variance in Travel Choice Intention among domestic visitors.

Key Consumer Insights

1. Social Influences (SI)

Social Influence acts as the strongest leverage factor ($\beta = 0.297$, $f^2 = 0.222$).

Vietnamese tourists make decisions based on social media trends, online communities, and e-WOM from family & friends.

2. Perceived Behavior Control (PBC)

Unlike international group tours, Vietnamese travelers value self-efficacy ($\beta = 0.239$). Important forecasting factor-rely on Context Dependence: Significant here for Vietnamese tourists - travelers prioritize autonomy, convenience, and a feeling of being "in control".

3. Economic Concerns (EC)

Weakest impact: Cost can be a barrier or a driver depending on the customer segment and the value structure they perceive



Vietnamese vs Inbound Comparison

Vietnamese Tourists (This Study)

- **Social Influence ($\beta=0.297$):** Dominant driver via peer e-WOM and TikTok trends.
- **PBC ($\beta=0.239$):** Highly significant; independent travel requires high self-efficacy.
- **Economic Concerns ($\beta=0.108$):** Value-for-money focus for budget getaways.

Inbound Tourists (Prior Work)

- **PBC Excluded:** Non-significant as tour packages handle itinerary logistics.
- **Destination Image Dominant:** Foreigners choose Hoi An primarily on iconic global branding.
- **Fixed Budgets:** Less price-sensitive on short stay costs.

Strategic Recommendations



Social Media First

Launch unified hashtag challenges and partner with micro-KOCs on short video platforms to maximize viral community outreach.



Smart Travel Enablers

Publish transparent budget-based 2D1N itineraries and integrate 1-click digital QR ticketing to remove planning friction.



Themed Immersion

Shift from passive ticket sales to experiential workshops (lantern-making, pottery villages, night river culture tours).

Implementation Roadmap

